

Roll Out a Fedora Remix

This article teaches you how to remix Fedora with your choice of apps, and roll out an ISO for others to enjoy.

To understand the idea of the Fedora Remix, use the Fedora time machine and take a peek into the past. From Fedora Core 1 to 6, Fedora had two repositories: Fedora Core, managed by Red Hat engineers and Fedora Extras, an add-on community repository managed by volunteers.

Fedora Core was built internally by Red Hat, and packages would end up in the classic Fedora CD set or DVD. Fedora Extras was built using a public build system, and the packages were only available as part of the repository and not on the installation media.

Over a period of time, the Fedora Project realised that this structure was creating artificial walls in the project, preventing everyone from working together as a single community. The project broke that wall down and from Fedora 7 onwards, there was just one giant repository in a public build system growing faster, with more and more packages.

This success created a problem, however—one could not put every single package into the media because it would grow to more than a DVD could hold, and so the Fedora release engineering team still had to play favourites. This had the potential to ignite the

classic Emacs vs Vim or GNOME vs KDE wars. Picking the 'right' defaults in a community project is a tricky job, since everyone has their own strong ideas on what they like.

To solve this in an elegant way, Fedora provided the tools to create Fedora variants called Fedora Spins, and gave the choice to participants in the community. Anyone interested could do their own Fedora release, and gather a community around their idea to use it and champion it. You could then think of Fedora releases as merely samples of what was possible.

Think of the Fedora Electronics Lab for instance. It has provided several different upstream projects a platform to work together, define a workflow, do integration testing, and it has also brought many people into Fedora and the free software world. This small but growing community of contributors with an interest in electronics now has an opportunity to use its expertise in a way that benefits a lot of people.

Spins and remixes

Fedora Spins are official Fedora releases targeted towards specific audiences. They are composed of pure packages from the